

TIMETABLED FREIGHT

ON OCTOBER 1, Indian Railways launched its first assured time container service between Delhi and Kolkata. In a significant shift, timetabled services are planned to be scaled up on several routes to ensure reliable delivery of goods that generally move by road. Commodity specific cargo services—grains, cement, automobile and export/import—are also being transitioned to timetabled movement to boost logistics services. It was a long-pending demand from operators to provide assured time services to compete with road services.



AI FUNDING BUBBLE?

WITH OPENAI OVERTAKING Elon Musk's SpaceX to become the world's most valuable privately held start-up at over \$500 billion, concerns of an AI funding bubble are mounting. Globally, AI start-ups raised \$73 billion in 2025, accounting for nearly 58% of all venture funding, research platform PitchBook data shows. In India, start-ups secured \$7.7 billion in the first nine months of 2025, ranking third worldwide, according to Tracxn. While median round sizes doubled despite a funding dip, analysts caution that valuations may be racing ahead of fundamentals, making sustainable innovation the real test.

\$7.4
BILLION

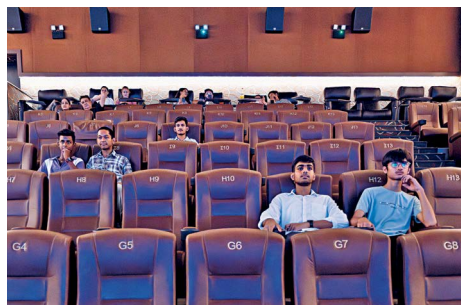
INVESTMENT BY DIIs IN SEPTEMBER 2025. FIIs SOLD \$2.1 BN IN INDIAN EQUITIES IN THE SAME PERIOD. DOMESTIC MFs INVESTED \$5.1 BN WHILE INSURANCE INFLOW WAS \$2.3 BN, ACCORDING TO HSBC MF

US TARIFF DRAMA

US PRESIDENT DONALD

Trump's announcement of a 100% tariff on films not made in the US is likely to have serious repercussions. The hardest hit is likely to be the Telugu industry, for which overseas markets are a big component of box-office collections, with the US alone accounting for 60%. The

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corresponding number for Hindi cinema is around 35%. At a time when Europe and the Middle East are offering subsidies for films to be shot there, the US market—from a production point of view—becomes less attractive. This script is writing itself.